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Telephony, Desk Phones and Softphone Issues

VoIP calls, voicemail, call forwarding, headsets and contact centre agents

Default priority: P3 Medium
(P2 if a team or reception is without phones)**Target response / resolution:** Respond in 15 min / resolve in 2 business hours**Handled by:** Tier 1, then Telephony team

Scope

Use this instruction for problems with desk phones, softphones, voicemail, call forwarding, number changes, and calling headsets.

Related instructions: WI-06 Network, WI-12 Video Conferencing, WI-18 Asset Management

Common symptoms

- Phone shows no dial tone or 'registering'
- Calls drop, crackle, or have one-way audio
- Voicemail not working or not delivering to email
- Call forwarding or hunt group not working
- Softphone cannot sign in

Information to collect

- User, extension or number, and location
- Desk phone model or softphone application
- Whether inbound, outbound, or both are affected
- Time of the failed calls, and the numbers involved

Resolution steps

- 1 Check for a wider fault.** See if other phones in the same area or building are affected, and check the telephony monitoring. If many are, escalate to the Telephony team at once.
- 2 Check power and connection.** Confirm a desk phone has power (network port or adapter) and a network cable. Try another port or a known-good cable.
- 3 Restart the device.** Power cycle the phone. For a softphone, sign out, close the app, and sign back in. Check the user's licence and extension assignment.
- 4 Check audio devices.** For one-way audio or poor quality, check the headset, volume, and the audio device selected. Test with another headset.
- 5 Check network quality.** Poor audio is often caused by network congestion or Wi-Fi. Test on a wired connection and check for VPN use, which can add delay.
- 6 Check call settings.** Confirm call forwarding, do-not-disturb, hunt group membership, and voicemail settings in the telephony portal.
- 7 Make a test call.** Place inbound and outbound calls with the user. Confirm voicemail and forwarding if relevant.

Escalate when

- Many phones or a whole site affected, or calls to emergency numbers cannot be made
- Contact centre queue or hunt group fault
- Trunk, number porting, or carrier faults

Resolution and closure

- Record the cause (device, network, licence, settings, carrier) and the fix
- Update the telephony asset and extension records
- Close after the user confirms inbound and outbound calls work

Quick troubleshooting reference

Symptom	Likely cause	What to do
Desk phone shows 'No service'	Network or power issue, or registration fault	Check the cable and port, restart the phone, and check registration in the portal.
One-way audio	NAT, firewall, headset, or Wi-Fi issue	Test on another headset and wired network. Escalate with call times if it persists.
Voicemail not reaching email	Mailbox link or voicemail settings	Check the voicemail configuration and the email address linked.
Calls not forwarding	Forwarding not set, or loop	Review settings in the portal and test with a call.
Softphone will not sign in	Licence, password, or MFA	Check the licence and credentials, then reinstall the app if needed.

Suggested wording for the user

Open	<i>"Is it only your phone, or are the phones around you affected too?"</i>
During	<i>"I am restarting your phone and checking its registration. It may take a couple of minutes."</i>
Close	<i>"Please place a test call to a mobile number and ask them to call you back so we know both directions work."</i>

Good practice

Do

- Ask whether emergency calling is affected
- Test calls in both directions
- Check licences and extension mapping
- Record the call times for faults

Do not

- Do not reset phones remotely during peak call times without warning
- Do not change hunt group settings without approval
- Do not share voicemail passwords
- Do not ignore a repeating fault

Worked example

A receptionist says callers hear nothing when she answers, but she can hear them.

Ticket note field	Entry
Issue reported	One-way audio on inbound calls since the morning. Outbound is fine.
Checks performed	Other phones are fine. Headset tested on a spare phone, which works.
Cause	Faulty headset cable.
Action taken	Replaced the headset and tested inbound and outbound calls.
Result	Audio works both ways. Closed after confirmation.

Analyst checklist

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|---|--|
| ☐ Check for a wider fault | ☐ Check call settings |
| ☐ Check power and connection | ☐ Make a test call |
| ☐ Restart the device | ☐ Ticket note completed using the standard template |
| ☐ Check audio devices | ☐ User confirmed the issue is resolved |
| ☐ Check network quality | |

Preventing repeat tickets

- Keep spare headsets and phones
- Use wired connections for desk phones
- Monitor call quality scores
- Review hunt groups and numbers every six months